

storing it in our Python session in a variable called `ess`:

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```
import pandas as pd
ess = pd.read_csv('ess.csv')
```

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Remember, in order to read the CSV file, you'll have to be storing it in the same place as you're running Python from, or you'll have to change `'ess.csv'` in the previous snippet to reflect the exact filepath where you're storing the CSV file. We can use the `shape` attribute of a `pandas` dataframe to see how many rows and columns are in our data:

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```
print(ess.shape)
```

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The output should be `(44387, 534)`, indicating that our dataset has 44,387 rows (one for each respondent) and 534 columns (one for each question in the survey). We can look more closely at some of the columns that interest us by using the `pandas` module's slicing functions. For example, here's how we look at the first five answers to the “happy” question:

---

```
print(ess.loc[:, 'happy'].head())
```

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Our dataset, `ess`, has 534 columns, one for each question in the survey. For some purposes, we may want to work with all 534 columns at once. Here, we want to look only at the `happy` column, not the other 533. That's why we used the `loc()` function. Here, the `loc()` function has sliced the variable called `happy` from the `pandas` dataframe. In other words, it takes out only that column and ignores the other 533. Then, the `head()` function shows us the first five rows of that column. You can see that the first five responses are 5, 5, 8, 8, and 5. We can do the same with the `sclmeet` variable:

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```
print(ess.loc[:, 'sclmeet'].head())
```

---

The result should be 6, 4, 4, 4, and 6. The `happy` responses and the `sclmeet` responses will line up in order. For example, the 134th element of `sclmeet` is a response given by the same person who gave the response in the 134th element of `happy`.

The ESS staff strives to get a complete set of responses from every survey participant. However, there are some cases where responses to some survey questions are missing, sometimes because a participant either